



When tech titans sling some mud...

...the insults just keep on coming. But who's complaining?

Arnab Mukherjee

arnab@dgit.in

Occasional multi-million dollar lawsuits and fierce marketing battles have become an entertaining aspect of tech rivalries that consumer have come to enjoy over the years. In fact, these rivalries have created an environment where publicly calling out the faults in a rival's products is a competitive practice.

These tongue in cheek slights, social media battles and thinly veiled insults are a sheer delight to watch/read. Here are some of those that just couldn't get enough of.

Google Pixel vs iPhone 7

Apple's bold statement of 'courage' in the removal of the headphone jack on the iPhone 7 received its own fair share of attention. Even though Chinese smartphone manufacturer LeEco had gotten there first, the world just waits for the Cupertino giant's announcements every year and the parodies that follow. With their own smartphone launch this year, Google also jumped into the fray in the Pixel smartphone announcement video. At the 43 second mark after highlighting a slew of new features, it declares, '3.5mm headphone jack satisfyingly *not* new', directly poking at the removal of the same from the iPhone 7. (Watch: <http://dgit.in/PixlHdphn>)

Everyone vs iPad

In September last year, Apple announced the massive 12.9 inch iPad Pro with much fanfare, proclaiming

it as the new way to compute. Jokes about Apple Pencil quickly followed the announcements. But the most important response came after Apple launched its 'What is a computer' commercial. In the commercial, Apple highlighted the new iPad Pro's flip keyboard, Apple Pencil compatibility and multi-window multitasking capabilities as things that made it an equal or even better than a full fledged computer. And guess who responded?

3.5mm headphone jack satisfyingly not new

Microsoft released a commercial within the fortnight that showed the iPad Pro and the Surface Pro 4 side by side, with the former celebrating a party for becoming a PC because it has a keyboard. Cortana, speaking from the Surface Pro 4, goes on to politely ask Siri about having an Intel Core i7 processor, an actual trackpad and external ports, along with full versions of Office rather than the apps. Needless to say, Siri quickly calls off the party. (Watch: Apple's ad: <http://dgit.in/iProCmptr>, Microsoft's response: <http://dgit.in/SProComptr>)

This wasn't the first time Microsoft was taking a dig at Apple's tablet. In



Microsoft trolling the iPad pro

Late 2013, Microsoft released a commercial titled Windows 8: Less talking more doing. In the advertisement, an iPad and a Windows 8 tablet are placed side by side, with Siri listing out things it cannot do that the Windows tablet is shown to be easily capable of. Pretty soon, in July 2013, they released a follow up ad that started with Siri going 'oh no, here we go again' and listed some more features like USB support, backstand and a physical detachable

keyboard, ending with Siri exclaiming that it hasn't ended well for her as the price difference between the two is shown to be \$250 in the favor of Microsoft. (watch: <http://dgit.in/AplVSMS1> and <http://dgit.in/AplVSMS2>)

Lumia 1020 vs everything else

Nokia dropped a bomb when it launched the Lumia 1020 in 2013 with its 41MP camera. Most of its ad campaigns for the phone (read: all of them) focussed on how amazing the camera was and how it made zooming altogether redundant with its high level of detail. One of the highlights of this entire campaign was a commercial that almost directly took down all its competitors in one fell swoop. The commercial showed a school play being attended by parents of the children acting in the play. As soon as the play begins, overeager parents, brandishing iPhones and Samsung smartphones quite visibly, realise that they aren't close enough to the stage to